

Continuous Monitoring Strategy

ALRP Authorization Boundary

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Baseline: NIST SP 800-53 Rev. 5 -- Moderate

Classification: Controlled Unclassified Information (CUI)

Status: Draft for pre-adjudication review

1. Strategy Purpose

The Continuous Monitoring Strategy describes how the organization maintains ongoing awareness of the security posture of the ALRP in support of the Authorizing Official's risk-based decisions. It defines the monitored controls, the assessment cadence, and the reporting flow.

2. Monitoring Scope

Monitoring spans technical detections, control-effectiveness sampling, vulnerability data, and configuration drift. Results are consolidated into a posture report delivered to the Authorizing Official and the system owner.

3. Control Implementations

CA-7 Continuous Monitoring

Continuous monitoring maintains ongoing awareness of the security posture in support of risk-based authorization decisions.

The continuous-monitoring control sample is assessed quarterly and the results reported to the Authorizing Official.

Findings are tracked to closure in the plan of action and milestones and summarized for the Authorizing Official.

IR-3 Incident Response Testing

Exercising the response plan validates that people, process, and tooling perform under realistic incident conditions.

Incident-response capabilities are exercised through tabletop and functional tests quarterly.

Exercises cover detection, containment, eradication, and recovery, and lessons learned feed back into the plan.

PM-14 Testing, Training, and Monitoring

A managed testing and training program measures and improves the effectiveness of the security capability over time.

The enterprise security testing and training program is evaluated for effectiveness biannually.

Program metrics are reviewed by leadership and drive investment in tooling, staffing, and curriculum.

SI-4 System Monitoring

System monitoring provides the detective controls that surface intrusions and policy violations in near-real time.

Security-monitoring detections and dashboards are reviewed daily by the Security Operations Center.

Detections forward to an alerting pipeline that pages the on-call analyst, who triages within the documented window.

4. Supporting Controls

CA-5 Plan of Action and Milestones

Identified weaknesses are documented with planned remediation and milestones, and progress is tracked to closure.

CA-6 Authorization

The Authorizing Official renders a risk-based authorization decision informed by the continuous-monitoring posture report.